

Statement of Purpose

Shao-Chen Hsu

Over seven years as an international news reporter at a major television network in Taiwan, I have leveraged English and Korean to build a versatile toolkit. I produce daily coverage and in-depth features, anchor newscasts, and report live from breaking news scenes. I covered South Korea's sudden martial law in late 2024 and the presidential election the following year. These assignments sharpened my ability to adapt quickly, speak with authority on camera, and identify underreported stories. Yet professional growth within Taiwan's media has clear limits, and I now seek training that will move me beyond those structural constraints.

June 2025 brought a defining test. After the U.S. military bombed Iranian nuclear facilities, misinformation and deepfake videos flooded platforms. Our newsroom relied almost entirely on searches through X, formerly Twitter, to assemble reports. I took the initiative to verify content and found that most videos were unrelated to actual events. That episode exposed severe fact-checking failures in Taiwanese media, where false material was not only unchallenged but amplified.

Years in television and video sharpened my on-air instincts, but I lack sustained practice in text-based and data-driven reporting. In a resource-constrained system, developing these skills has been difficult. Berkeley's Multimedia and Web Video track will let me develop cross-platform storytelling and interactive reporting that extend beyond the broadcast frame.

I am eager to take J 222, Interactive Narratives, to integrate video, data, AR, VR, and other formats into immersive digital journalism. I also plan to enroll in J 298, *Developing Your Blockbuster Investigative Story*, to strengthen research, data analysis, and a rigorous fact-checking framework. Workshops and visual journalism courses will provide sustained mentorship and a structured path to sharpen storytelling. This training will help me turn complex material into pieces that are both in-depth and interactive, meeting the habits of today's digital audiences and addressing the resource gaps that constrain Taiwanese newsrooms.

After the program, I will report on animal welfare and the environment while using Mandarin, Korean, and English to cover U.S.–Taiwan diplomacy, Taiwan and South Korea's technology cooperation, and shifting U.S.–China dynamics. I will examine transnational crime as well, including the expansion of Chinese and Taiwanese fraud networks in the United States. Through such work, I aim to show Taiwan's diverse international identity and move beyond a narrow focus on semiconductors and geopolitics.

I also plan to give back to Taiwan's journalism community by serving as a consultant and participating in media forums that promote fact-checking systems and professional training, reinforcing journalism's public responsibility. With Berkeley's resources, mentorship, and standards, I will become a journalist who brings a global perspective and contributes to meaningful media reform. My ultimate goal is to help Taiwan's news industry embrace its role in protecting the truth within a democratic society. Berkeley will give me the technical fluency, investigative discipline, and ethical rigor to verify hard facts, debunk viral falsehoods, and build interactive narratives that earn public trust and strengthen Taiwan's information resilience for years to come.